

Decision Maker		
You are a	Corporate/Government/ Educational Institution	SoHo/Home User
You need to OCR	Faxed/photocopied/type-written documents/newspapers and magazines/contracts/tenders with text and tables, with high levels of accuracy	Documents containing text and tables with basic formatting, occasional newspaper and magazine clippings, with average accuracy
Our pick	OmniPage Pro 11, ABBYY FineReader 6.0 CE	PageGenie Pro 4.0, Readiris Pro 7
Price	Rs 10,000 and above	Up to Rs 10,000

that are misaligned or even not clearly formed. It therefore becomes difficult for the OCR engine to recognise the characters and it has to guess the correct letter or number.

OmniPage Pro 11 scored the highest here, returning an amazing 95.99 per cent accuracy. This score was way ahead of that logged by FineReader 6.0 CE, which managed only 86.25 per cent accuracy. OmniPage Pro 11 also managed to retain the layout fairly accurately, with only two bullet points missing out of 10.

Readiris Pro 7 was the best at retaining format and layout here—it retained the layout with 100 per cent accuracy. But it returned a paltry 29 per cent accuracy in reading the text.

What it all leads to...

It was a tough fight between ABBYY FineReader 6.0 CE and OmniPage Pro 11 all through the test. Both are priced at Rs 25,000 and score well all across the board. Nonetheless, ABBYY FineReader 6.0 CE edges ahead purely because of its ability to retain layouts and formatting

across a wide range of media types.

The area where ABBYY FineReader 6.0 CE really shows its mettle is in the combi document—it was the only software to retain all



If you can afford it, FineReader 6.0 CE is the best OCR software bar none!

the formatting and styling elements along with an accuracy score of over 96 per cent!

HATIM KANTAWALLA and ALIASGAR PARDAWALA

1/2 page AD